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Rally targets midterms, GOP's future

Vance sets stage for presidential bid, but Trump in limelight

By **Shane Goldmacher and Lisa Lerer**
THE NEW YORK TIMES

DALLAS — Vice President JD Vance was billed as the headliner of the second night of the Republican convention, but President Donald Trump stole the show.

With a hug and a handshake, Vance exited stage right after his speech as Trump returned to the place he likes most — center stage — to make his final pitch of the convention to keep Republicans in power.

At one point Trump asked attendees to raise their right hands and pledge to him that they would vote with their family and friends. Dutifully, they did.

“You know what happens if you don’t vote?” Trump said. “You go to hell.”

The two-day rally in Dallas came as Trump’s approval has sagged below 40% and Republicans fear losing control of both the House and Senate.

Republicans hoped the gathering would help energize a base beleaguered by high prices and the Iran war to turn out in droves.

But the two days of red meat tossed from the stage seemed unlikely to satiate independent voters whose support has flagged.

Here are five takeaways from the convention.

VANCE MAKES HIS 2026 (AND 2028) PITCH

Vance arrived in Dallas widely considered the front-runner in the 2028 Republican presidential primary. His speech offered some early clues about how he might approach a campaign.

Vance focused on restoring the primacy of the traditional nuclear American family, a theme he has championed in the administration.

He did not mention the war in Iran, an operation he has defended publicly but raised concerns about privately.

But he issued a plea for conservatives not to abandon the White House over policy. “Do not throw the baby out with the bathwater,” he urged.

But he failed to sustain the kind of enthusiasm that Trump commanded either night. Nor did he win anything beyond perfunctory praise from the president, who quickly ushered him off the stage.

As the balloons fell, it was the president alone, along with a tenor

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ANTONIO PEREZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

CHICAGO FIREFIGHTERS REMEMBER 9/11 ATTACKS

Chicago firefighters salute as elected officials and members of the public pay tribute at Navy Pier on Friday, the 25th anniversary of the 9/11 terrorist attacks in the United States.

Chicago prepares for Mexican Independence Day celebrations

Some street closures possible this weekend

By **Allison Kiehl**
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Hundreds of thousands of people are expected to flood the city of Chicago to celebrate Mexican Independence Day this weekend at the city’s signature parades and festivals. A crowd of around 400,000 people is expected at the annual Mexican Independence Parade in Little Village alone, organizers say.

Mexican Independence Day is observed each year on Sept. 16. This year, city officials and organizers are trying to keep celebrations at the parades and festivals, rather than in the streets of the Loop, where car caravans of red,



A motorcyclist shields his face from the setting sun while riding on West 26th Street in Chicago’s Little Village neighborhood on Friday.
JOHN J. KIM/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

white and green have previously brought the city’s downtown traffic to a standstill.

In 2019, hundreds took over downtown on the eve of Mexican Independence Day. Traffic on East Wacker Drive remained stagnant

for hours as people honked car horns, danced and cheered while waving Mexican flags in a crowd that was mostly peaceful, police said at the time. Since then, the

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Judge plans to appoint receiver over West Suburban, Weiss hospitals

By **Lisa Schencker**
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

A Cook County judge said Friday he plans to appoint a receiver over West Suburban and Weiss Memorial hospitals to get them “under control,” after months of battles in court over their future.

Though the hospitals’ current owners and many community members have said they want to see the safety net hospitals reopened, the receiver’s immediate job won’t be to reopen the facilities, but rather to stabilize the situation, Cook County Circuit Judge Patrick Stanton said at a hearing Friday afternoon.

“We’re not talking about who can get these reopened right now,” Stanton said. “We’re talking about getting things secured and getting

control, and we’ll go from there. I do not do this lightly.”

The judge has not yet decided who the receiver will be.

The decision to appoint a receiver is a blow for the hospitals’ current operator, Resilience Healthcare, which is majority-owned by Dr. Manoj Prasad, who had sought to continue managing the hospitals.

It’s a win, however, for the hospitals’ landlord, Ramco Healthcare Holdings, which began asking the judge to appoint a receiver months ago.

Stanton said at a hearing early Friday afternoon that a number of problems over the last couple of months have convinced him that a receiver is necessary. He said

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Officials warn of measles exposure

City health officials are warning of a measles exposure at Union Station after someone with the highly contagious disease passed through the West Loop hub. **Chicagoland, A3**

CIA releases intelligence report

Tucked at the end of a Sept. 10, 1998, intelligence report sent to President Bill Clinton’s White House was a warning about al-Qaida. **Nation & World, B4**

D’Andre Swift agrees to extension

The Bears have agreed to terms with Swift on a three-year, \$33.75 million contract extension with \$27.5 million guaranteed. **Sports, C1**

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